



ADATA HV610 USB 3.0

It combines picture puzzle design concept with USB 3.0 interface.
<http://dgit.in/07P9Mn>



Capture the game

AverMedia Game Capture HD C281 lets you take snapshots while you are gaming on your Xbox 360 or PS3

and KeePassX (www.keepassx.com) integrate with your workflow quite well, and are known to be very secure, using multi-factor authentication and strong methods of data encryption.

Lastpass, for example, requires you to remember a single password to a 'vault' that holds the login credentials to your other online accounts. Lastpass will automatically sign you into websites whose login information you've stored (thus thwarting any keyloggers that may be installed on your system without your knowledge), automatically generate a random password for every new service you sign up for and fill up online forms for you. It's quite robust and works on nearly every platform with browser extensions for Mozilla Firefox, Google Chrome, Apple's Safari, Microsoft's Internet Explorer and Opera as well as mobile and desktop applications for nearly all devices. It also has a few handy features such as a virtual keyboard to prevent keyboard sniffers and a one-time password that you can use when logging in from an untrusted computer. If you're wary of holding all your credentials in one digital egg basket, Lastpass offers multi-factor authentication. Multi-factor authentication essentially means your password alone isn't sufficient to sign you in. Lastpass offers Grid multi-factor authentication for

its free users or you can choose to use the Google Authenticator app for smartphones in conjunction with Lastpass as well. In the former, you are required to print out a grid that contains some codes. While logging in, you'll be asked for a code on the grid corresponding to a specific row and column. Even if your LastPass account password was to be compromised, your password data would still be safe.

Google's Two-Factor authentication isn't new, but it's a very effective and little-known second layer of defence for your Google (or LastPass) account. It works by setting up your mobile phone with your Google account, along with a backup number in case you misplace your phone. Whenever you need to log in to a Google service like Gmail or Google Reader, you'll first have to enter your password, and then a 6-digit code will be sent to your mobile using SMS. Only after successfully authenticating will you be allowed access to your data. In case you misplace your phone, you can choose to have the verification code sent to your backup phone(s). (You don't have to do this every time; you can mark some devices as 'trusted' for a period of 30 days). If you're in a place without cellular network, Google provides a smartphone app called the Google Authenticator that can perform a similar function. (This app can also be configured to work with LastPass for an extra layer of security).

Finally, if all else fails, Google provides you with a set of ten codes that you can print out and keep with you at all times. These are one-use codes and can be used in case of an emergency if you don't have access to your phone or are in a place without cellular

network. If you have a Google account, we strongly recommend that you set up two-factor authentication RIGHT NOW. Here's the link: <http://goo.gl/8GQrj> (Facebook also provides two-step verification called 'Login Approvals' that works similarly)

Another weakness in Mat's case, was that all his accounts were chained to one another, and by gaining access to one account, hackers could infiltrate all of them. Make sure this isn't true in your case. Ensure that all your major online accounts like your primary email, social networks and bank accounts are isolated from one another. If possible, use separate emails for these services and use a slightly different identifier (the part that comes before the @ sign in an email address) for each service. Email is free, and if you think you'll have trouble remembering all those passwords (remember to use unique passwords), let LastPass handle it for you.

Another oft overlooked item, is the security question. Never answer security questions honestly. Most services don't let you choose your question and anyone who knows you personally may be able to answer (or guess the answer) to the question. Instead, use wacky, unconventional answers that only you know of. Make up funny phrases completely unrelated to the question. You can use the secure notes feature of Lastpass to store a list of these wacky phrases in case you ever forget them. (Just like your passwords, these notes are encrypted and safely stored in your vault.)

Lastly, if your device itself were to be stolen, make sure you have a form of remote login or remote wipe configured. iOS users can use the 'Find my iPhone' feature to remote login and wipe their devices, and



Avast Mobile Security is a free app with Anti-Theft features

Android users can use the Google Apps 'Device Policy' app (<http://goo.gl/5I1GF>) to remote wipe the contents of their stolen or misplaced device. Note that this will only wipe the internal storage and not any of the data stored on the SD card. To wipe the SD card as well, consider using an app like Android Lost that has a tonne of other security features as well. As a precautionary measure, consider installing Prey, a software that can track the location of a stolen device and can email you details including its location, periodic screenshots of the device and snapshots from the device's camera / webcam. It's cross platform and available for laptops as well as smartphones, so there's no reason why you shouldn't set it up!

No amount of security is going to be 100 per cent fail-safe, but in the wake of recent events, reviewing your digital security is a necessity. While some of the methods mentioned above may cause some inconvenience at first, the added security in the long run makes it worth it. After all, you'd rather be safe than sorry!

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Lastpass' Grid Multifactor Authentication is an effective way to secure your account